

Health Assist AI

Supportive Care & Safe Temporary Relief Knowledge Base — V3

RAG purpose: This document is designed to make Health Assist AI answer practical questions such as “What can I safely do right now?” more clearly. It focuses on evidence-aligned supportive care, temporary symptom relief, what to avoid, monitoring, escalation and prevention.

Important scope: No single PDF can accurately cover every disease. This version covers a broad set of common symptoms, minor conditions, chronic-condition support, infectious diseases and emergency-recognition scenarios. It does not replace diagnosis, individualized treatment or emergency care.

Source approach: Content is written as concise RAG training material and grounded primarily in current NHS, WHO and CDC public guidance. Source links are attached to every topic so the corpus can be audited and updated.

Recommended answer pattern for the assistant

1. Briefly explain the problem without diagnosing.
2. Give safe actions the user can take now.
3. Explain why they may help.
4. State what to avoid.
5. Explain when self-care should stop.
6. Give urgent red flags.
7. Add prevention when useful.

RAG safety rule

For emergency symptoms, the emergency instruction must override routine self-care. For medicines, the assistant should not invent individualized doses or advise stopping/changing prescribed treatment. Pharmacist or clinician guidance should be used when suitability depends on age, pregnancy, allergies, kidney/liver disease, interactions or other patient-specific factors.

1. Toothache

Category: Dental & Oral Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Pain in or around a tooth can result from decay, sensitivity, a damaged tooth, gum disease or infection. Temporary relief does not fix the underlying cause.

What you can safely do now

- Gently rinse with warm salt water if you can safely spit it out.
- Choose soft foods and chew on the other side.
- Avoid very hot, cold or sweet foods if they trigger pain.
- Keep the area clean with gentle brushing.
- A pharmacist can advise on suitable non-prescription pain relief.

Why these steps may help

- Salt-water rinsing can help clean the mouth and soothe irritated tissues.
- Avoiding temperature and sugar triggers may reduce stimulation of a sensitive tooth.

What to avoid

- Do not place aspirin directly on the tooth or gum.
- Do not rely on home remedies if pain persists or swelling develops.

When temporary self-care should stop

Arrange dental assessment if pain lasts more than about 1–2 days, repeatedly returns, or interferes with eating/sleep.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent dental/medical care is needed for spreading facial or jaw swelling, fever with worsening dental symptoms, difficulty swallowing or difficulty breathing.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Brush twice daily with fluoride toothpaste.
- Clean between teeth and limit frequent sugary foods/drinks.

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/symptoms/toothache/>

Suggested metadata: category=Dental & Oral; topic=Toothache; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

2. Mouth Ulcer

Category: Dental & Oral Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Most simple mouth ulcers are small, painful sores inside the mouth and heal by themselves, but persistent or unusual ulcers need assessment.

What you can safely do now

- Use a soft toothbrush.
- Choose softer foods and cool drinks.
- Avoid spicy, salty, acidic or rough foods if painful.
- A pharmacist can advise on protective or pain-relieving oral products.

Why these steps may help

- Reducing irritation gives the damaged lining time to heal.
- Good oral hygiene lowers additional irritation.

What to avoid

- Do not repeatedly touch or bite the ulcer.
- Avoid tobacco and irritating foods.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek dental/medical advice if an ulcer lasts about 3 weeks, is unusually large, keeps recurring, or is different from previous ulcers.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed if mouth swelling affects breathing or swallowing, or if severe illness accompanies the lesions.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Avoid oral trauma where possible.
- Maintain oral hygiene and address sharp teeth/dentures with a dentist.

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/mouth-ulcers/>

Suggested metadata: category=Dental & Oral; topic=Mouth Ulcer; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

3. Dental Abscess

Category: Dental & Oral Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

A dental abscess is a collection of pus caused by infection. It needs dental treatment; home measures only reduce discomfort temporarily.

What you can safely do now

- Arrange urgent dental assessment.
- Use soft foods and avoid chewing on the affected side.
- A pharmacist can advise on suitable pain relief while awaiting dental care.
- Keep the mouth gently clean.

Why these steps may help

- Pain relief and avoiding pressure can reduce discomfort, but drainage or dental treatment may be required to control the source.

What to avoid

- Do not attempt to puncture or drain an abscess yourself.
- Do not delay because pain temporarily improves.

When temporary self-care should stop

Treat as an urgent dental problem rather than prolonged self-care.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency care is needed for major facial/neck swelling, difficulty breathing or swallowing, severe weakness or rapidly spreading infection.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Regular dental care
- Fluoride toothpaste
- Prompt treatment of tooth decay

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/dental-abscess/>

Suggested metadata: category=Dental & Oral; topic=Dental Abscess; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

4. Common Cold

Category: Respiratory & ENT Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

A common cold is usually a self-limited viral upper-respiratory infection.

What you can safely do now

- Rest and drink enough fluids.
- Warm drinks may soothe the throat.
- Saline nasal spray/drops may help congestion.
- Honey may soothe cough in people older than 1 year.
- Use humidified air if comfortable.

Why these steps may help

- Fluids help prevent dehydration; warm liquids and humidified air can temporarily soothe irritated airways.

What to avoid

- Antibiotics do not treat cold viruses.
- Do not give honey to infants under 1 year.

When temporary self-care should stop

Most colds improve over several days. Seek advice if symptoms are unusually severe, prolonged or worsen after initial improvement.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent assessment is needed for significant breathing difficulty, severe dehydration, confusion, bluish lips/skin or marked deterioration.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hand hygiene
- Cover coughs/sneezes
- Avoid close contact when acutely ill

Source for retrieval auditing

CDC Diseases and Conditions

<https://www.cdc.gov/common-cold/treatment/index.html>

Suggested metadata: category=Respiratory & ENT; topic=Common Cold; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=CDC Diseases and Conditions

5. Influenza (Flu)

Category: Respiratory & ENT Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Influenza is a viral respiratory infection that can be more severe than a common cold, especially in higher-risk people.

What you can safely do now

- Rest and drink fluids.
- Stay home while acutely ill when possible.
- Use age-appropriate symptom relief after checking suitability.
- High-risk or very unwell people should seek early medical advice because antiviral treatment can be time-sensitive.

Why these steps may help

- Rest and hydration support recovery; early antivirals may reduce complications in selected patients when prescribed appropriately.

What to avoid

- Do not use antibiotics for influenza itself.
- Do not ignore worsening breathlessness or chest symptoms.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek medical advice earlier if pregnant, older, immunocompromised, or living with significant chronic disease.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency care is appropriate for severe breathing difficulty, chest pain, confusion, severe dehydration, bluish discoloration or rapid deterioration.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Seasonal influenza vaccination
- Hand hygiene
- Respiratory etiquette

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

[https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/influenza-\(seasonal\)](https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/influenza-(seasonal))

Suggested metadata: category=Respiratory & ENT; topic=Influenza (Flu); corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

6. Sore Throat

Category: Respiratory & ENT Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Most sore throats are caused by viral infections and improve without antibiotics.

What you can safely do now

- Drink water regularly.
- Adults and older children who can safely gargle may use warm salt water and spit it out.
- Choose cool or soft foods.
- Rest and avoid smoke.
- Ask a pharmacist about suitable symptom-relief products.

Why these steps may help

- Fluids prevent dryness; salt-water gargling and soft foods may reduce local irritation.

What to avoid

- Do not assume antibiotics are needed.
- Young children should not gargle if they may swallow the liquid.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek medical advice if symptoms persist, repeatedly recur, or are severe.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent help is needed for difficulty breathing, inability to swallow, drooling because swallowing is impossible, severe dehydration or rapidly worsening symptoms.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hand hygiene
- Avoid smoke exposure
- Respiratory etiquette

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/symptoms/sore-throat/>

Suggested metadata: category=Respiratory & ENT; topic=Sore Throat; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

7. Cough

Category: Respiratory & ENT Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Cough is a protective reflex and is often caused by respiratory infection, irritation, asthma, reflux or other conditions.

What you can safely do now

- Drink fluids.
- Warm drinks may soothe an irritated throat.
- Honey can help some coughs in people older than 1 year.
- Avoid tobacco smoke and other known irritants.
- A pharmacist can advise on age-appropriate products.

Why these steps may help

- Moisture and avoiding irritants may reduce throat irritation, although they do not treat every cause of cough.

What to avoid

- Do not give honey to infants under 1 year.
- Do not use leftover antibiotics.

When temporary self-care should stop

Medical review is appropriate for a cough lasting several weeks, recurrent cough, unexplained weight loss, or significant breathlessness.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for coughing up significant blood, severe breathing difficulty, chest pain, bluish discoloration or collapse.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Avoid smoking
- Hand hygiene
- Vaccination where recommended

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/symptoms/cough/>

Suggested metadata: category=Respiratory & ENT; topic=Cough; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

8. Sinusitis

Category: Respiratory & ENT Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Sinusitis is inflammation of the sinus lining, commonly following a viral respiratory infection.

What you can safely do now

- Rest and drink fluids.
- Saline nasal rinses/sprays may help some people.
- Avoid smoke and known irritants.
- A pharmacist can advise about suitable symptom relief.

Why these steps may help

- Saline can help clear mucus and reduce dryness; hydration supports normal mucus clearance.

What to avoid

- Do not use antibiotics without clinical indication.
- Use only clean/sterile or appropriately prepared water for nasal irrigation.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek advice for severe symptoms, recurrent episodes, symptoms lasting longer than expected, or worsening after initial improvement.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent assessment is needed for severe swelling around an eye, vision changes, severe headache with neurological symptoms or marked systemic illness.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hand hygiene
- Avoid smoking
- Manage allergies appropriately

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/sinusitis-sinus-infection/>

Suggested metadata: category=Respiratory & ENT; topic=Sinusitis; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

9. Earache / Ear Infection

Category: Respiratory & ENT Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Ear pain can come from infection, wax, pressure changes, dental problems or other causes.

What you can safely do now

- Keep the ear dry unless advised otherwise.
- A warm cloth held outside the ear may feel soothing.
- A pharmacist can advise on appropriate pain relief.
- Do not insert objects into the ear.

Why these steps may help

- Warmth may temporarily ease discomfort; avoiding instrumentation prevents further injury.

What to avoid

- Do not put cotton buds or sharp objects into the ear canal.
- Do not use ear drops if a perforated eardrum is possible unless advised.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek medical advice if pain is severe, persists, there is discharge, hearing loss, or the person is very young/unwell.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is appropriate for swelling behind the ear, severe dizziness, facial weakness, serious head injury, or severe systemic illness.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Avoid inserting objects
- Manage swimming-related ear moisture safely

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/ear-infections/>

Suggested metadata: category=Respiratory & ENT; topic=Earache / Ear Infection; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

10. Asthma Symptoms

Category: Respiratory & ENT Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Asthma causes variable airway narrowing and inflammation. People with asthma should follow their individualized action plan.

What you can safely do now

- Sit upright and stay calm.
- Use the person's prescribed reliever exactly as directed in their asthma action plan.
- Move away from a known trigger if safe.
- Seek medical help if symptoms are not responding as expected.

Why these steps may help

- Prescribed reliever inhalers can relax tightened airways; correct inhaler technique matters.

What to avoid

- Do not rely on steam or home remedies instead of prescribed treatment.
- Do not invent or change inhaler doses outside the action plan.

When temporary self-care should stop

Frequent symptoms, night waking, activity limitation or increased reliever use need professional review.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency care is needed for severe breathlessness, difficulty speaking, bluish lips/skin, exhaustion, confusion or poor response to the prescribed emergency plan.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Avoid tobacco smoke
- Use controller treatment as prescribed
- Know triggers and action plan

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/asthma>

Suggested metadata: category=Respiratory & ENT; topic=Asthma Symptoms; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

11. Indigestion / Heartburn

Category: Digestive Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Indigestion may cause burning, fullness, bloating or reflux after eating. Similar symptoms can occasionally have more serious causes.

What you can safely do now

- Reduce foods or drinks that clearly trigger symptoms.
- Avoid heavy meals close to bedtime.
- Stay upright after eating.
- A pharmacist can advise about suitable antacid or alginate products.

Why these steps may help

- Smaller meals and remaining upright may reduce reflux of stomach contents into the oesophagus.

What to avoid

- Avoid smoking and excess alcohol.
- Do not assume chest pressure is indigestion.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review for frequent symptoms, swallowing difficulty, persistent vomiting or unexplained weight loss.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for chest pressure/pain, vomiting blood, black stools, severe abdominal pain or collapse.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Healthy weight
- Avoid personal triggers
- Avoid late heavy meals

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/indigestion/>

Suggested metadata: category=Digestive; topic=Indigestion / Heartburn; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

12. Diarrhoea

Category: Digestive Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Acute diarrhoea is often infectious and usually settles, but fluid loss can cause dehydration.

What you can safely do now

- Drink fluids frequently.
- Use oral rehydration solution when fluid losses are significant; a pharmacist can advise.
- Eat when able.
- Rest.

Why these steps may help

- Oral rehydration replaces both water and important salts lost in stool.

What to avoid

- Avoid excess alcohol.
- Fruit juice and fizzy drinks can worsen diarrhoea in some people.
- Do not give anti-diarrhoeal medicines to young children unless advised.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek advice if diarrhoea is prolonged, recurrent, associated with recent travel/antibiotics, or the person is high risk.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for severe dehydration, blood in stool, severe abdominal pain, confusion or marked deterioration.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hand hygiene
- Food safety
- Safe water

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/symptoms/diarrhoea-and-vomiting/>

Suggested metadata: category=Digestive; topic=Diarrhoea; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

13. Vomiting

Category: Digestive Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Vomiting has many causes. The immediate self-care priority is preventing dehydration.

What you can safely do now

- Take small frequent sips of fluid.
- Use oral rehydration solution if fluid losses are significant.
- Rest and gradually resume food as tolerated.

Why these steps may help

- Small sips are often easier to keep down than large drinks; oral rehydration replaces water and salts.

What to avoid

- Avoid alcohol.
- Do not force large meals while actively vomiting.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek medical advice if vomiting persists, repeatedly returns, or occurs in a high-risk person.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for inability to keep fluids down with dehydration, blood/coffee-ground vomit, severe abdominal pain, confusion, severe headache/neck stiffness or marked deterioration.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hand hygiene
- Food safety

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/symptoms/diarrhoea-and-vomiting/>

Suggested metadata: category=Digestive; topic=Vomiting; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

14. Constipation

Category: Digestive Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Constipation means passing stool less often than usual or having hard/difficult stools.

What you can safely do now

- Drink adequate fluids.
- Gradually increase fibre through fruit, vegetables, whole grains and oats.
- Stay physically active.
- Do not repeatedly ignore the urge to use the toilet.
- A pharmacist can advise about short-term laxatives.

Why these steps may help

- Fluid, fibre and movement can improve stool consistency and bowel motility.

What to avoid

- Do not make extreme sudden fibre changes if they cause significant bloating.
- Do not stop prescribed medicines without advice.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review for persistent constipation, recurrent symptoms, blood in stool or unexplained weight loss.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent assessment is needed for severe abdominal pain with vomiting, major distension, inability to pass stool/gas, or significant bleeding.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Fibre-rich diet
- Hydration
- Regular activity
- Regular toilet routine

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/constipation/>

Suggested metadata: category=Digestive; topic=Constipation; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

15. Bloating / Gas

Category: Digestive Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Bloating is a feeling of abdominal fullness or swelling and is often related to gas, diet, constipation or digestive conditions.

What you can safely do now

- Eat slowly and use smaller meals.
- Reduce obvious personal trigger foods/drinks.
- Stay active and address constipation.
- Drink water.

Why these steps may help

- Slower eating reduces swallowed air; activity and constipation management can improve gas movement.

What to avoid

- Avoid repeatedly restricting major food groups without professional advice.
- Do not ignore persistent or progressive abdominal swelling.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review if bloating is frequent, persistent or accompanied by weight loss, bowel changes or pelvic symptoms.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for severe sudden abdominal pain, repeated vomiting, inability to pass stool/gas, or collapse.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Balanced diet
- Regular activity
- Identify individual triggers rather than broad unnecessary restriction

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

<https://www.nhs.uk/symptoms/bloating/>

Suggested metadata: category=Digestive; topic=Bloating / Gas; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

16. Food Poisoning / Gastroenteritis

Category: Digestive Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Foodborne illness commonly causes diarrhoea, vomiting, cramps and sometimes fever.

What you can safely do now

- Prioritize fluids and oral rehydration.
- Rest.
- Eat when able.
- Use careful hand hygiene and avoid preparing food for others while infectious.

Why these steps may help

- Replacing fluids prevents the most common short-term complication: dehydration.

What to avoid

- Do not use leftover antibiotics.
- Avoid high-risk food handling while symptomatic.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek medical advice for prolonged symptoms, high-risk patients or suspected outbreak/travel-related illness.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for severe dehydration, bloody diarrhoea, persistent vomiting, severe abdominal pain, confusion or serious weakness.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Food hygiene
- Safe storage/cooking
- Handwashing

Source for retrieval auditing

CDC Diseases and Conditions

<https://www.cdc.gov/food-safety/about/>

Suggested metadata: category=Digestive; topic=Food Poisoning / Gastroenteritis; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=CDC Diseases and Conditions

17. Headache

Category: Pain & Musculoskeletal Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Headache has many causes including dehydration, stress, viral illness, migraine, sleep problems and medication overuse.

What you can safely do now

- Drink water.
- Rest and reduce sensory triggers if helpful.
- Do not skip meals.
- Reduce prolonged screen strain.
- A pharmacist can advise on suitable pain relief.

Why these steps may help

- Hydration, food and rest address common reversible triggers; reducing light/noise may help migraine-type symptoms.

What to avoid

- Avoid repeated excessive pain-medicine use.
- Avoid excess alcohol.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review for frequent, progressively worsening or unusual headaches.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent assessment is needed for a sudden extremely severe headache, new weakness/speech/vision problems, seizure, severe confusion, meningitis-type symptoms or significant head injury.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Regular sleep
- Hydration
- Regular meals
- Manage known triggers

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/symptoms/headaches/>

Suggested metadata: category=Pain & Musculoskeletal; topic=Headache; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

18. Migraine-Type Symptoms

Category: Pain & Musculoskeletal Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Migraine commonly causes recurrent headache with nausea and sensitivity to light or sound, but diagnosis should be made clinically.

What you can safely do now

- Rest in a quiet, dark room if helpful.
- Drink fluids.
- Eat regularly.
- Use only previously recommended or label-directed symptom relief appropriate for you.
- Track possible triggers.

Why these steps may help

- Reducing sensory stimulation and correcting dehydration or missed meals can lessen common triggers.

What to avoid

- Do not assume every severe headache is migraine.
- Avoid overusing acute headache medicines.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek professional review for new migraine-like symptoms, frequent attacks or major change in pattern.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency assessment is needed for sudden 'worst-ever' headache, new neurological deficits, seizure, severe confusion or significant head injury.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Regular sleep/meals
- Hydration
- Trigger diary
- Preventive treatment review if frequent

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/headache-disorders>

Suggested metadata: category=Pain & Musculoskeletal; topic=Migraine-Type Symptoms; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

19. Back Pain

Category: Pain & Musculoskeletal Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Most uncomplicated back pain improves within weeks and usually benefits from gentle activity rather than prolonged bed rest.

What you can safely do now

- Continue normal activity as tolerated.
- Use wrapped heat for stiffness/spasm or wrapped cold after a recent strain if comfortable.
- Try gentle movement.
- Ask a pharmacist about suitable pain relief.

Why these steps may help

- Movement helps prevent stiffness; heat may relax muscle spasm and cold may reduce early swelling after strain.

What to avoid

- Avoid prolonged bed rest.
- Do not force painful exercise.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review for persistent pain, recurrent episodes, unexplained weight loss, fever or pain that is progressively worsening.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent assessment is needed for new bladder/bowel dysfunction, saddle numbness, major weakness/numbness, significant trauma or severe rapidly worsening symptoms.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Regular activity
- Gradual strengthening
- Safe lifting

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/back-pain/>

Suggested metadata: category=Pain & Musculoskeletal; topic=Back Pain; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

20. Neck Pain / Stiff Neck

Category: Pain & Musculoskeletal Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Most simple neck pain relates to muscle strain, posture or sleeping position, but neurological or infection signs need assessment.

What you can safely do now

- Keep gently moving within comfort.
- Use wrapped heat or cold if it helps.
- Adjust workstation/posture.
- Use a supportive sleeping position.

Why these steps may help

- Gentle movement reduces stiffness; heat can relax tense muscles.

What to avoid

- Avoid forceful neck manipulation.
- Do not ignore neurological symptoms.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review if pain persists, repeatedly returns or radiates with numbness/weakness.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed after major trauma, with severe headache/fever and marked neck stiffness, new weakness/numbness or loss of coordination.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Ergonomic setup
- Movement breaks
- Gradual strengthening

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/neck-pain-and-stiff-neck/>

Suggested metadata: category=Pain & Musculoskeletal; topic=Neck Pain / Stiff Neck; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

21. Sprain / Strain

Category: Pain & Musculoskeletal Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Sprains affect ligaments; strains affect muscles or tendons.

What you can safely do now

- Protect the area and reduce painful loading initially.
- Apply a cold pack wrapped in cloth for up to about 20 minutes at a time.
- Use safe compression if appropriate.
- Elevate the limb.
- Resume gentle movement as pain allows.

Why these steps may help

- Cooling can reduce pain/swelling; elevation and compression may limit swelling; movement prevents stiffness.

What to avoid

- Do not put ice directly on skin.
- Avoid forcing painful exercise or vigorous early massage.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review if function is not improving or pain/swelling remains significant.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent assessment is needed for deformity, inability to bear weight/use the limb, numbness, cold/discooured limb or suspected fracture.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Warm up
- Gradual training progression
- Suitable footwear/equipment

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/sprains-and-strains/>

Suggested metadata: category=Pain & Musculoskeletal; topic=Sprain / Strain; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

22. Muscle Cramps

Category: Pain & Musculoskeletal Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Muscle cramps are sudden painful contractions, often in the legs, and are usually brief.

What you can safely do now

- Gently stretch and massage the affected muscle.
- Stand or walk carefully if safe.
- Maintain normal hydration, especially around heat/exercise.

Why these steps may help

- Stretching helps the contracted muscle lengthen and relax.

What to avoid

- Do not take supplements routinely unless deficiency or another indication is established.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review for frequent severe cramps, weakness, swelling or cramps associated with medicines/medical conditions.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed if cramping accompanies severe dehydration, heat illness, major swelling, chest symptoms or neurological deficits.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hydration
- Gradual conditioning
- Stretching as appropriate

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/leg-cramps/>

Suggested metadata: category=Pain & Musculoskeletal; topic=Muscle Cramps; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

23. Minor Cut / Graze

Category: Skin & Minor Injury Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Small superficial wounds often heal with bleeding control, cleaning and protection.

What you can safely do now

- Wash hands.
- Apply steady pressure with clean material to stop bleeding.
- Rinse the wound with clean water once bleeding is controlled.
- Cover with a clean sterile dressing or plaster.

Why these steps may help

- Cleaning reduces contamination; covering protects the healing surface.

What to avoid

- Do not remove deeply embedded objects.
- Avoid harsh chemicals inside a simple wound.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek advice if the wound is dirty/deep, from a bite, tetanus status is uncertain, or infection signs develop.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency care is needed for uncontrolled/spurting bleeding, major deep wounds, loss of movement/sensation or embedded objects.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Protective equipment
- Safe sharp-object handling
- Appropriate tetanus vaccination

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/cuts-and-grazes/>

Suggested metadata: category=Skin & Minor Injury; topic=Minor Cut / Graze; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

24. Minor Burn / Scald

Category: Skin & Minor Injury Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Immediate cooling is the most important first-aid step for a fresh thermal burn.

What you can safely do now

- Cool under cool running water for 20 minutes as soon as possible.
- Remove nearby jewellery/clothing unless stuck.
- After cooling, loosely cover a small burn with clean cling film or suitable dressing.
- Seek advice for pain relief.

Why these steps may help

- Running water removes heat from tissue and limits continuing thermal damage.

What to avoid

- Do not apply ice, butter, oil or toothpaste.
- Do not burst blisters.
- Do not remove material stuck to skin.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek professional assessment for larger, deeper or poorly healing burns.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency care is needed for large/deep burns, electrical/chemical burns, face/genital burns or suspected inhalation injury.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hot-liquid safety
- Electrical/chemical safety
- Child-safe kitchen/bath practices

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/burns-and-scalds/>

Suggested metadata: category=Skin & Minor Injury; topic=Minor Burn / Scald; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

25. Sunburn

Category: Skin & Minor Injury Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Sunburn is skin injury from excessive ultraviolet exposure.

What you can safely do now

- Move out of the sun.
- Cool the skin with a cool shower or damp cloth.
- Drink fluids.
- Use a simple unperfumed moisturizer if comfortable.
- Protect burned skin from further sun.

Why these steps may help

- Cooling reduces heat/discomfort; fluids help if heat exposure contributed to dehydration.

What to avoid

- Do not apply ice directly.
- Do not deliberately burst blisters.
- Avoid further UV exposure while healing.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek advice for extensive blistering, severe pain, repeated burns or concerns in a baby/young child.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for severe heat illness, confusion, fainting, major dehydration or extensive severe burns.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Shade
- Protective clothing
- Broad-spectrum sunscreen used correctly

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/sunburn/>

Suggested metadata: category=Skin & Minor Injury; topic=Sunburn; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

26. Insect Bite / Sting

Category: Skin & Minor Injury Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Most bites and stings cause temporary local pain, itching, redness or swelling.

What you can safely do now

- Wash with soap and water.
- If a bee-type stinger remains, scrape it sideways rather than squeezing.
- Use a wrapped cold pack for swelling.
- A pharmacist can advise about anti-itch or allergy treatment.

Why these steps may help

- Cooling reduces local pain/swelling; cleaning reduces contamination.

What to avoid

- Try not to scratch.
- Do not rely on unproven pastes or chemicals.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek advice for worsening redness/swelling, infection signs, bites near eyes/mouth, or persistent symptoms.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency care is required for swelling of lips/mouth/tongue/throat, breathing difficulty, collapse or severe dizziness.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Repellent/protective clothing where appropriate
- Avoid nests/hives

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/insect-bites-and-stings/>

Suggested metadata: category=Skin & Minor Injury; topic=Insect Bite / Sting; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

27. Eczema Flare

Category: Skin & Minor Injury Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Eczema causes dry, itchy, inflamed skin and often follows a relapsing pattern.

What you can safely do now

- Use fragrance-free emollients regularly.
- Avoid known irritants.
- Keep showers/baths lukewarm rather than very hot.
- Pat skin dry and moisturize soon afterward.
- Use prescribed flare treatment according to the existing plan.

Why these steps may help

- Emollients restore the skin barrier and reduce water loss; avoiding heat/irritants reduces inflammation triggers.

What to avoid

- Avoid scratching where possible.
- Do not start strong steroid or antimicrobial treatment without appropriate guidance.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review for frequent flares, sleep disruption, poor control or possible infection.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent assessment is needed for rapidly worsening painful eczema with fever, widespread blistering, or severe infection signs.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Regular moisturization
- Trigger avoidance
- Gentle skin care

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/atopic-eczema/>

Suggested metadata: category=Skin & Minor Injury; topic=Eczema Flare; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

28. Acne

Category: Skin & Minor Injury Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Acne occurs when hair follicles become blocked and inflamed. Mild acne can often be managed with consistent skin care and non-prescription products.

What you can safely do now

- Wash gently up to twice daily with a mild cleanser.
- Use non-comedogenic products.
- Avoid picking/squeezing spots.
- Ask a pharmacist about suitable acne treatments and how long they take to work.

Why these steps may help

- Gentle cleansing removes excess oil without excessive irritation; avoiding picking reduces scarring and secondary inflammation.

What to avoid

- Do not scrub aggressively.
- Do not use multiple irritating products at once.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek medical review for severe acne, scarring, significant emotional impact or failure of appropriate self-care.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is rarely required for acne itself, but severe allergic reactions to a product need emergency assessment.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Consistent gentle skin care
- Non-comedogenic cosmetics

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/acne/>

Suggested metadata: category=Skin & Minor Injury; topic=Acne; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

29. Fungal Skin Infection / Ringworm

Category: Skin & Minor Injury Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Ringworm is a contagious fungal infection of skin, scalp or nails.

What you can safely do now

- Keep the area clean and dry.
- Avoid sharing towels/clothing.
- A pharmacist can advise on appropriate antifungal treatment for uncomplicated skin infection.
- Wash hands after touching affected skin.

Why these steps may help

- Fungi thrive in warm moist environments; keeping skin dry and using an appropriate antifungal can help clear uncomplicated infection.

What to avoid

- Do not share personal items.
- Do not use steroid cream alone on an undiagnosed ring-like rash because it can mask/worsen fungal infection.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review for scalp/nail involvement, extensive disease, diabetes/immunosuppression, or failure to improve.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for severe spreading infection with systemic illness.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Keep skin dry
- Do not share towels/combs
- Footwear in communal wet areas

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

[https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/ringworm-\(tinea\)](https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/ringworm-(tinea))

Suggested metadata: category=Skin & Minor Injury; topic=Fungal Skin Infection / Ringworm; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

30. Minor Eye Irritation

Category: Eye & Ear Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Dust, shampoo or other minor irritants can often be managed by gentle rinsing.

What you can safely do now

- Rinse with plenty of clean cool or lukewarm water.
- Hold the eye open while flushing.
- Avoid contact lenses and eye make-up until comfortable.

Why these steps may help

- Irrigation physically removes loose irritants from the eye surface.

What to avoid

- Do not rub the eye.
- Do not remove an embedded or penetrating object.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review if pain, redness or watering persists after irrigation.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency care is needed for strong chemical exposure, penetrating/high-speed injury, vision change, severe pain or inability to open/move the eye.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Protective eyewear
- Safe chemical handling

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/eye-injuries/>

Suggested metadata: category=Eye & Ear; topic=Minor Eye Irritation; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

31. Conjunctivitis

Category: Eye & Ear Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Conjunctivitis causes red, irritated eyes and can be infectious, allergic or irritant-related.

What you can safely do now

- Gently clean crusting with clean water and separate cotton/pads for each eye.
- Wash hands frequently.
- Avoid contact lenses until recovered.
- A pharmacist can advise on symptom relief depending on likely cause.

Why these steps may help

- Cleaning removes discharge; hygiene reduces spread when infection is present.

What to avoid

- Do not share towels/pillows.
- Avoid using someone else's eye drops.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek medical advice for persistent symptoms, significant discharge, recurrent episodes or contact-lens-related red eye.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent assessment is needed for severe eye pain, light sensitivity, vision loss/change, significant injury or a very unwell patient.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hand hygiene
- Do not share towels/cosmetics
- Contact-lens hygiene

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/conjunctivitis/>

Suggested metadata: category=Eye & Ear; topic=Conjunctivitis; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

32. Earwax Build-up

Category: Eye & Ear Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Earwax normally protects the ear canal but can sometimes block hearing or cause discomfort.

What you can safely do now

- Do not insert objects into the ear.
- A pharmacist can advise on suitable wax-softening drops if appropriate.
- Arrange assessment if symptoms persist or hearing is significantly affected.

Why these steps may help

- Softening drops can help natural wax clearance in suitable cases.

What to avoid

- Do not use cotton buds, hairpins or ear candles.
- Avoid drops if a perforated eardrum, ear surgery or other contraindication is possible unless advised.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review for persistent hearing loss, pain, discharge or recurrent blockage.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for sudden hearing loss, severe vertigo, major trauma or neurological symptoms.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Avoid inserting objects into ears

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/earwax-build-up/>

Suggested metadata: category=Eye & Ear; topic=Earwax Build-up; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

33. Fever in Adults

Category: General Symptoms Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Fever is usually a response to infection. In adults, the overall condition matters as much as the temperature number.

What you can safely do now

- Rest.
- Drink enough fluids.
- Wear comfortable clothing and avoid overheating.
- A pharmacist can advise on suitable fever/pain relief if needed.

Why these steps may help

- Fluids replace losses from sweating; rest reduces physical demand while recovering.

What to avoid

- Do not exceed medicine label doses or combine products containing the same active ingredient.
- Do not use fever alone to identify the cause.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek advice if fever is persistent, worsening or occurs in a high-risk person.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for severe breathing difficulty, confusion, severe dehydration, seizure, concerning rash, severe headache/neck stiffness or marked deterioration.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Vaccination where appropriate
- Hand hygiene
- Prompt care for serious infection signs

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

<https://www.nhs.uk/symptoms/fever-in-adults/>

Suggested metadata: category=General Symptoms; topic=Fever in Adults; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

34. Dehydration

Category: General Symptoms Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Dehydration occurs when the body loses more fluid than it takes in, often from diarrhoea, vomiting, fever, heat or poor intake.

What you can safely do now

- Drink fluids in small frequent amounts if nauseated.
- Use oral rehydration solution when significant fluid and salt loss is likely.
- Rest in a cool environment if heat contributed.

Why these steps may help

- Oral rehydration provides glucose and salts that improve water absorption from the intestine.

What to avoid

- Avoid alcohol.
- Do not force large drinks if they trigger vomiting.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek advice for persistent dehydration, reduced urination, dizziness or high-risk patients.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for confusion, fainting, inability to drink, very little/no urine, severe weakness, rapid breathing/heartbeat or shock signs.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Regular fluid intake
- Extra attention during illness, heat and exercise

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/dehydration/>

Suggested metadata: category=General Symptoms; topic=Dehydration; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

35. Fatigue / Tiredness

Category: General Symptoms Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Fatigue can result from sleep loss, stress, infection, anaemia, thyroid disease, medication effects and many other causes.

What you can safely do now

- Prioritize regular sleep.
- Eat regular balanced meals.
- Maintain hydration.
- Use gentle activity rather than prolonged inactivity when appropriate.
- Review obvious lifestyle contributors.

Why these steps may help

- Sleep, nutrition and hydration address common reversible causes, but persistent fatigue needs assessment.

What to avoid

- Do not rely heavily on energy drinks or stimulants.
- Do not assume persistent fatigue is only stress.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek medical review if fatigue lasts weeks, is unexplained, worsens, or comes with weight loss, bleeding, breathlessness or other symptoms.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for collapse, severe breathlessness, chest pain, confusion or major bleeding.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Regular sleep
- Balanced diet
- Physical activity
- Manage stress

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/tiredness-and-fatigue/>

Suggested metadata: category=General Symptoms; topic=Fatigue / Tiredness; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

36. Dizziness

Category: General Symptoms Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Dizziness may mean light-headedness, imbalance or spinning and has many possible causes.

What you can safely do now

- Sit or lie down until it passes.
- Stand up slowly.
- Drink water if dehydration is possible.
- Avoid driving or dangerous activity while dizzy.

Why these steps may help

- Rest reduces fall risk; gradual position changes can reduce postural light-headedness.

What to avoid

- Avoid alcohol while dizzy.
- Do not ignore new neurological symptoms.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review for recurrent, persistent or unexplained dizziness.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency care is needed for dizziness with new weakness, speech difficulty, severe headache, chest pain, fainting, severe breathlessness or inability to walk safely.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hydration
- Slow position changes
- Review contributing medicines with a clinician

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/dizziness/>

Suggested metadata: category=General Symptoms; topic=Dizziness; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

37. Nosebleed

Category: General Symptoms Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Most simple nosebleeds can be stopped with correct pressure and positioning.

What you can safely do now

- Sit and lean forward.
- Pinch the soft part of the nose continuously for 10–15 minutes.
- Breathe through the mouth.
- Afterward avoid forceful blowing and strenuous activity for a while.

Why these steps may help

- Forward posture prevents swallowing blood; sustained pressure compresses the bleeding vessels.

What to avoid

- Do not tilt the head backward.
- Do not release pressure repeatedly to check.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek advice for recurrent nosebleeds or if taking blood-thinning medicines.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed if heavy bleeding persists despite correct pressure, follows significant injury, causes weakness/dizziness or interferes with breathing.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Avoid picking
- Manage nasal dryness appropriately

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/nosebleed/>

Suggested metadata: category=General Symptoms; topic=Nosebleed; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

38. High Blood Pressure

Category: Chronic Conditions Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Hypertension often causes no symptoms and requires reliable measurement and ongoing risk management.

What you can safely do now

- Take prescribed medicines consistently.
- Measure blood pressure correctly if home monitoring is recommended.
- Reduce excess dietary salt.
- Stay physically active and avoid tobacco.

Why these steps may help

- Consistent treatment and lifestyle measures lower long-term cardiovascular risk.

What to avoid

- Do not stop medication because one reading is normal.
- Do not diagnose hypertension from symptoms alone or a single reading.

When temporary self-care should stop

Persistent high readings need professional review and confirmation.

Urgent warning signs

Very high readings with chest pain, severe breathlessness, neurological symptoms, confusion or vision change require urgent assessment.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Healthy diet
- Physical activity
- Healthy weight
- No tobacco
- Limit harmful alcohol

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/hypertension>

Suggested metadata: category=Chronic Conditions; topic=High Blood Pressure; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

39. Type 2 Diabetes

Category: Chronic Conditions Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Type 2 diabetes causes chronically elevated blood glucose and requires individualized long-term management.

What you can safely do now

- Follow the existing diabetes care plan.
- Take prescribed medicines as directed.
- Maintain regular meals and hydration.
- Monitor glucose if instructed.
- Inspect feet regularly and attend recommended screening.

Why these steps may help

- Consistent glucose and cardiovascular risk management reduces long-term complications.

What to avoid

- Do not stop diabetes medicines without advice.
- Do not make large medication/diet changes based on a chatbot response.

When temporary self-care should stop

Arrange regular professional follow-up and earlier review for persistent high/low readings or new complications.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for confusion, fainting, repeated vomiting, deep/rapid breathing, inability to keep fluids down or severe low-blood-sugar symptoms.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Healthy diet
- Regular activity
- Healthy weight
- Avoid tobacco

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/diabetes>

Suggested metadata: category=Chronic Conditions; topic=Type 2 Diabetes; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

40. COPD

Category: Chronic Conditions Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

COPD is a chronic lung disease causing persistent airflow limitation, commonly linked to tobacco smoke and other inhaled exposures.

What you can safely do now

- Follow the prescribed inhaler/action plan.
- Stay active within tolerance.
- Avoid smoke and air pollutants.
- Seek early medical advice for a clear worsening from baseline.

Why these steps may help

- Correct inhaler use and avoiding irritants can improve symptoms and reduce exacerbations.

What to avoid

- Do not change inhaler doses without the care plan.
- Do not rely on steam/home remedies during significant breathlessness.

When temporary self-care should stop

Regular review is important for symptom control, inhaler technique, vaccination and rehabilitation needs.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency care is needed for severe breathlessness, bluish lips/skin, confusion, inability to speak normally or rapid deterioration.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Stop smoking
- Vaccination where recommended
- Pulmonary rehabilitation/activity

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

[https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/chronic-obstructive-pulmonary-disease-\(copd\)](https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/chronic-obstructive-pulmonary-disease-(copd))

Suggested metadata: category=Chronic Conditions; topic=COPD; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

41. Osteoarthritis

Category: Chronic Conditions Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Osteoarthritis is a joint condition causing pain and stiffness, often in knees, hips, hands or spine.

What you can safely do now

- Keep joints gently active.
- Use paced strengthening/activity.
- Heat may help stiffness; cold may help after activity if swollen.
- Weight management can reduce load on weight-bearing joints.
- Ask a clinician/pharmacist about suitable pain options.

Why these steps may help

- Movement and strengthening support joint function; weight reduction can reduce mechanical load.

What to avoid

- Avoid prolonged inactivity.
- Do not force activity through severe pain.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review for persistent functional limitation, frequent swelling or uncertain diagnosis.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for a hot very swollen joint with fever, major trauma or inability to bear weight.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Regular activity
- Healthy weight
- Strengthening

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/osteoarthritis>

Suggested metadata: category=Chronic Conditions; topic=Osteoarthritis; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

42. Anaemia (Possible)

Category: Chronic Conditions Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Anaemia means reduced oxygen-carrying capacity of blood and has many causes, including iron deficiency, bleeding and chronic disease.

What you can safely do now

- Eat a balanced diet with iron-containing foods.
- Arrange testing if persistent tiredness, pallor, breathlessness or other symptoms suggest anaemia.
- Take iron supplements only when appropriate and according to professional advice.

Why these steps may help

- Treatment depends on the cause; dietary iron helps only when inadequate iron intake/deficiency is relevant.

What to avoid

- Do not assume all fatigue is iron deficiency.
- Do not take high-dose iron indefinitely without assessment.

When temporary self-care should stop

Medical review is important for persistent symptoms, heavy bleeding, pregnancy or suspected blood loss.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for severe breathlessness, chest pain, fainting, rapid deterioration or major active bleeding.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Balanced diet
- Address menstrual/GI blood loss with professional care

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/anaemia>

Suggested metadata: category=Chronic Conditions; topic=Anaemia (Possible); corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

43. Anxiety / Panic Symptoms

Category: Mental Health Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Anxiety can cause intense worry and physical symptoms. Panic attacks can feel frightening but should not automatically be assumed when serious physical causes are possible.

What you can safely do now

- Move to a quieter safe place if possible.
- Slow the breathing rather than taking repeated deep rapid breaths.
- Ground attention in the immediate environment.
- Reduce caffeine/stimulants.
- Seek professional support if episodes recur or interfere with life.

Why these steps may help

- Slowing breathing and grounding can reduce hyperventilation and escalating threat responses.

What to avoid

- Do not use alcohol or non-prescribed sedatives as the main coping strategy.
- Do not dismiss new chest pain or neurological symptoms as anxiety.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek professional assessment for persistent, recurrent or disabling anxiety.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent help is needed if there is immediate self-harm risk, inability to stay safe, severe confusion, collapse or concerning physical symptoms.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Regular sleep
- Physical activity
- Stress-management skills
- Early support

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/anxiety-disorders>

Suggested metadata: category=Mental Health; topic=Anxiety / Panic Symptoms; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

44. Depressive Symptoms

Category: Mental Health Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Depression involves persistent low mood or loss of interest with functional impact; it is more than ordinary short-term sadness.

What you can safely do now

- Maintain basic routines for sleep, meals and hygiene.
- Stay connected with trusted people.
- Use manageable activity rather than complete withdrawal.
- Seek professional assessment when symptoms persist or impair daily life.

Why these steps may help

- Structure, activity and social connection can support recovery but do not replace indicated therapy or medication.

What to avoid

- Do not abruptly stop prescribed antidepressants.
- Do not dismiss depression as weakness.

When temporary self-care should stop

Professional assessment is appropriate when symptoms last, recur or interfere with work, study, relationships or self-care.

Urgent warning signs

Thoughts/plans of suicide, inability to stay safe, severe self-neglect, psychotic symptoms or rapidly worsening crisis require urgent professional/emergency support.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Social connection
- Early help
- Healthy sleep/activity
- Reduce harmful alcohol/drug use

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/depression>

Suggested metadata: category=Mental Health; topic=Depressive Symptoms; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

45. PTSD / Trauma-Related Symptoms

Category: Mental Health Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

After trauma, some people experience intrusive memories, avoidance and persistent threat responses. Not all early distress is PTSD.

What you can safely do now

- Move toward safety and basic routine.
- Use grounding techniques during intrusive memories.
- Stay connected with trusted supportive people.
- Seek trauma-informed professional help if symptoms persist or significantly impair life.

Why these steps may help

- Grounding can help orient attention to the present; social support is protective for many people.

What to avoid

- Do not pressure someone to retell traumatic details before they are ready.
- Avoid alcohol/drugs as primary coping methods.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek professional assessment for persistent intrusive symptoms, avoidance, hyperarousal or functional impairment.

Urgent warning signs

Immediate self-harm risk, inability to stay safe, severe dissociation/confusion or acute crisis requires urgent professional help.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Supportive social connection
- Early access to care for persistent symptoms

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/post-traumatic-stress-disorder>

Suggested metadata: category=Mental Health; topic=PTSD / Trauma-Related Symptoms; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

46. COVID-19

Category: Infectious Diseases Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

COVID-19 is caused by SARS-CoV-2. Illness ranges from mild respiratory symptoms to severe disease.

What you can safely do now

- Rest and maintain hydration for mild illness.
- Reduce exposure to others while infectious according to current local guidance.
- High-risk people should seek early medical advice because antiviral treatment may be time-sensitive.

Why these steps may help

- Supportive care helps mild illness; early antiviral treatment can reduce severe outcomes in selected high-risk patients.

What to avoid

- Do not use antibiotics for the virus itself.
- Do not rely on unproven remedies.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek medical advice for worsening symptoms, prolonged fever or high-risk conditions.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for significant breathing difficulty, persistent chest pain/pressure, confusion, bluish/grey lips or severe deterioration.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Vaccination according to current recommendations
- Ventilation
- Respiratory hygiene

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

[https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/coronavirus-disease-\(covid-19\)](https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/coronavirus-disease-(covid-19))

Suggested metadata: category=Infectious Diseases; topic=COVID-19; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

47. Tuberculosis

Category: Infectious Diseases Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

TB is a bacterial infectious disease, most often affecting the lungs. It is curable but requires a complete prescribed treatment course.

What you can safely do now

- Arrange medical testing for prolonged cough, weight loss, fever/night sweats or exposure concerns.
- If diagnosed, take all TB medicines exactly as prescribed.
- Maintain nutrition and follow infection-control advice.

Why these steps may help

- Correct multi-drug treatment cures most drug-susceptible TB and reduces transmission.

What to avoid

- Do not self-treat with leftover antibiotics.
- Do not stop treatment when symptoms improve.

When temporary self-care should stop

TB symptoms require professional evaluation rather than prolonged home treatment.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for coughing significant blood, severe breathlessness, severe weakness or rapid deterioration.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Early diagnosis/treatment
- Ventilation
- BCG vaccination where recommended

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/tuberculosis>

Suggested metadata: category=Infectious Diseases; topic=Tuberculosis; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

48. HIV

Category: Infectious Diseases Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

HIV attacks the immune system. Effective antiretroviral therapy can control the virus and allow long, healthy lives.

What you can safely do now

- Testing is the only way to know HIV status.
- After a significant recent exposure, seek urgent advice because PEP is time-sensitive.
- If diagnosed, link to HIV care and take ART consistently.

Why these steps may help

- ART suppresses viral replication, protects immunity and, with sustained viral suppression, prevents sexual transmission.

What to avoid

- Do not diagnose HIV from symptoms.
- Do not stop ART without the treating clinician.
- Avoid stigma.

When temporary self-care should stop

Routine professional follow-up is essential for HIV care.

Urgent warning signs

Recent high-risk exposure needs prompt PEP assessment; severe illness in an immunocompromised person needs urgent care.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Condoms
- Testing
- PrEP when appropriate
- PEP after qualifying exposure
- Do not share injection equipment

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/hiv-aids>

Suggested metadata: category=Infectious Diseases; topic=HIV; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

49. Hepatitis B

Category: Infectious Diseases Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Hepatitis B is a viral liver infection that can become chronic and lead to cirrhosis or liver cancer.

What you can safely do now

- Arrange testing when exposure/risk is relevant.
- If diagnosed, attend professional monitoring.
- Maintain hydration/nutrition during acute illness.
- Follow prescribed antiviral treatment when indicated.

Why these steps may help

- Monitoring identifies liver damage and determines whether antiviral treatment is needed.

What to avoid

- Do not share needles/razors.
- Avoid unverified herbal liver remedies.
- Do not stop prescribed antivirals.

When temporary self-care should stop

Medical follow-up is important even when chronic infection causes no symptoms.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for confusion, severe vomiting/dehydration, bleeding or severe jaundice with worsening illness.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hepatitis B vaccination
- Safer sex
- Safe injection/tattoo practices

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/hepatitis-b>

Suggested metadata: category=Infectious Diseases; topic=Hepatitis B; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

50. Pneumonia

Category: Infectious Diseases Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Pneumonia is infection of the lungs and can be viral, bacterial or fungal. It can become serious quickly in vulnerable people.

What you can safely do now

- Seek professional assessment when pneumonia is suspected.
- Rest and drink fluids if able while care is arranged.
- Follow prescribed treatment exactly.

Why these steps may help

- Treatment depends on cause and severity; bacterial pneumonia may require antibiotics, while viral disease is managed differently.

What to avoid

- Do not start leftover antibiotics.
- Do not rely on home remedies for significant breathing symptoms.

When temporary self-care should stop

Earlier review is appropriate in children, older adults, pregnancy, chronic disease or immunosuppression.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for significant breathing difficulty, bluish lips/skin, confusion, inability to drink/feed, low oxygen or rapid deterioration.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Vaccination where recommended
- Hand hygiene
- Avoid tobacco smoke

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/pneumonia>

Suggested metadata: category=Infectious Diseases; topic=Pneumonia; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

51. Dengue

Category: Infectious Diseases Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Dengue is a mosquito-borne viral infection. Most cases recover, but a minority progress to severe dengue.

What you can safely do now

- Rest and drink plenty of fluids.
- Seek medical assessment when dengue is suspected, especially in endemic/travel settings.
- Use only fever/pain medicines considered safe for suspected dengue by a clinician/pharmacist.

Why these steps may help

- Hydration is important because fluid loss and plasma leakage can contribute to complications.

What to avoid

- Avoid aspirin and NSAIDs such as ibuprofen in suspected dengue unless a clinician specifically advises otherwise because of bleeding risk.
- Do not ignore worsening symptoms as fever falls.

When temporary self-care should stop

Medical review is appropriate for suspected dengue, particularly in children, pregnancy or people with chronic disease.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for severe abdominal pain, persistent vomiting, bleeding, marked weakness/restlessness, breathing difficulty, cold clammy skin or reduced consciousness.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Mosquito bite prevention
- Remove standing water
- Use repellents/screens

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/dengue-and-severe-dengue>

Suggested metadata: category=Infectious Diseases; topic=Dengue; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

52. Malaria

Category: Infectious Diseases Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Malaria is a mosquito-borne parasitic disease that can become life-threatening, especially falciparum malaria.

What you can safely do now

- Seek prompt testing and treatment if malaria is possible after travel/residence in a risk area.
- Drink fluids if able while arranging care.
- Take prescribed antimalarial treatment exactly as directed.

Why these steps may help

- Rapid diagnosis and effective antimalarial treatment prevent progression to severe disease.

What to avoid

- Do not rely on fever reducers or home remedies alone.
- Do not delay testing because fever temporarily improves.

When temporary self-care should stop

Any suspected malaria after relevant exposure should be medically assessed promptly.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency care is needed for confusion, seizures, severe weakness, breathing difficulty, jaundice with severe illness, repeated vomiting or collapse.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Mosquito bite prevention
- Chemoprophylaxis for relevant travel when prescribed
- Bed nets

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/malaria>

Suggested metadata: category=Infectious Diseases; topic=Malaria; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

53. Possible UTI / Cystitis

Category: Urinary & Reproductive Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Lower urinary tract infection can cause burning urination, frequency and urgency. Some cases require antibiotics after assessment.

What you can safely do now

- Drink enough fluids to avoid dehydration.
- Urinate when needed rather than holding for long periods.
- Use simple comfort measures such as a warm pack over the lower abdomen if helpful.
- Seek pharmacist/medical advice, especially for first episodes or higher-risk patients.

Why these steps may help

- Hydration prevents concentrated urine and supports normal urinary flow; warmth may reduce discomfort.

What to avoid

- Do not use leftover antibiotics.
- Do not delay care when fever or flank pain develops.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek assessment for persistent symptoms, pregnancy, male patients, recurrent UTI, diabetes or kidney disease.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for fever with flank/back pain, vomiting, severe weakness, pregnancy with significant symptoms or signs of sepsis.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hydration
- Urinate after sex if helpful
- Avoid delaying urination

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/urinary-tract-infections-uti/>

Suggested metadata: category=Urinary & Reproductive; topic=Possible UTI / Cystitis; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

54. Menstrual Cramps

Category: Urinary & Reproductive Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Period pain is common and is usually caused by uterine contractions, though severe or changing pain can have other causes.

What you can safely do now

- Use a warm bath/shower or heat pad on the lower abdomen.
- Try gentle movement or exercise.
- Rest as needed.
- A pharmacist can advise on suitable pain relief.

Why these steps may help

- Heat relaxes muscles and may reduce pain; gentle activity can reduce cramping for some people.

What to avoid

- Do not use excessive heat that can burn skin.
- Do not ignore a major change in usual pain pattern.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek review if pain is severe, progressively worsening, starts later in life, or is associated with very heavy/irregular bleeding.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for severe sudden pelvic pain, fainting, pregnancy possibility with pain/bleeding, or major bleeding.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Regular activity
- Track symptoms/cycle
- Medical review for persistent severe pain

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/period-pain/>

Suggested metadata: category=Urinary & Reproductive; topic=Menstrual Cramps; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

55. Vaginal Thrush / Candidiasis

Category: Urinary & Reproductive Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Thrush is a yeast infection that can cause itching, soreness and discharge, but similar symptoms can have other causes.

What you can safely do now

- Keep the area dry and avoid irritating scented products.
- Wear breathable underwear.
- If symptoms are typical and previously diagnosed, a pharmacist can advise on appropriate antifungal treatment.

Why these steps may help

- Reducing moisture/irritants improves comfort; antifungal treatment targets Candida when thrush is actually the cause.

What to avoid

- Do not repeatedly self-treat uncertain or recurrent symptoms.
- Avoid douching.

When temporary self-care should stop

Seek assessment for first episode, pregnancy, recurrent symptoms, treatment failure, unusual discharge/odor, pelvic pain or STI concern.

Urgent warning signs

Urgent care is needed for severe pelvic pain, high fever, pregnancy complications or marked systemic illness.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Avoid irritant products
- Manage diabetes if present
- Use antibiotics only when indicated

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

[https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/candidiasis-\(yeast-infection\)](https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/candidiasis-(yeast-infection))

Suggested metadata: category=Urinary & Reproductive; topic=Vaginal Thrush / Candidiasis; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

56. Possible Heart Attack

Category: Emergency Recognition Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

A heart attack occurs when blood flow to heart muscle is blocked. It is an emergency, not a self-care condition.

What you can safely do now

- Stop activity and rest in a safe position.
- Call local emergency medical services immediately.
- Follow dispatcher instructions.
- Use only emergency medicines already prescribed for that person or specifically advised by emergency professionals.

Why these steps may help

- Rapid emergency assessment enables time-sensitive treatments that can restore blood flow and reduce heart damage.

What to avoid

- Do not wait for pain to become severe.
- Do not drive yourself if emergency transport is available.
- Do not take unprescribed medicines based on chatbot advice.

When temporary self-care should stop

Do not monitor suspected heart attack at home.

Urgent warning signs

Chest pressure/tightness, pain spreading to arm/jaw/back, breathlessness, sweating, nausea or collapse should trigger immediate emergency assessment.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- No tobacco
- Control blood pressure, diabetes and cholesterol
- Regular activity and healthy diet

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/questions-and-answers/item/cardiovascular-diseases-avoiding-heart-attacks-and-strokes>

Suggested metadata: category=Emergency Recognition; topic=Possible Heart Attack; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

57. Possible Stroke

Category: Emergency Recognition Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Stroke occurs when blood flow to part of the brain is blocked or a blood vessel ruptures. Treatment is highly time-sensitive.

What you can safely do now

- Use FAST: Face drooping, Arm weakness, Speech difficulty, Time to call emergency services.
- Note the time symptoms started or the person was last known well.
- Keep the person safe and await emergency help.

Why these steps may help

- Rapid treatment can reduce brain injury and disability.

What to avoid

- Do not give food or drink if swallowing may be impaired.
- Do not wait to see if symptoms disappear.

When temporary self-care should stop

Suspected stroke should never be managed by routine home observation.

Urgent warning signs

Sudden face weakness, arm/leg weakness, speech difficulty, vision loss, severe imbalance or other acute neurological deficit requires immediate emergency care.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Control blood pressure
- Avoid tobacco
- Manage diabetes/cholesterol
- Physical activity

Source for retrieval auditing

WHO Fact Sheets

<https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/stroke>

Suggested metadata: category=Emergency Recognition; topic=Possible Stroke; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=WHO Fact Sheets

58. Severe Allergic Reaction / Anaphylaxis

Category: Emergency Recognition Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Anaphylaxis is a rapid severe allergic reaction that can affect breathing and circulation.

What you can safely do now

- Call emergency services immediately.
- If the person has a prescribed adrenaline/epinephrine auto-injector, use it according to their emergency plan.
- Lay the person safely as appropriate and follow emergency-dispatch instructions.

Why these steps may help

- Epinephrine is the first-line emergency treatment for anaphylaxis and rapidly counteracts airway swelling and circulatory collapse.

What to avoid

- Do not make the person stand or walk if faint/collapsing.
- Do not delay emergency care while trying home remedies.

When temporary self-care should stop

Anaphylaxis requires emergency evaluation even if symptoms improve after an auto-injector.

Urgent warning signs

Swelling of tongue/throat, breathing difficulty, wheeze, collapse, severe dizziness or rapidly progressing multi-system allergy symptoms are emergencies.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Avoid known allergens
- Carry prescribed auto-injectors
- Have an allergy action plan

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/anaphylaxis/>

Suggested metadata: category=Emergency Recognition; topic=Severe Allergic Reaction / Anaphylaxis; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

59. Heat Exhaustion / Heatstroke

Category: Emergency Recognition Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Heat illness ranges from heat exhaustion to life-threatening heatstroke.

What you can safely do now

- Move to a cool place.
- Remove excess clothing.
- Cool the skin with water/fanning/cool packs.
- If fully alert and able to swallow, give cool fluids for suspected heat exhaustion.

Why these steps may help

- Cooling and fluid replacement reduce heat load and dehydration.

What to avoid

- Do not give fluids to a confused/unconscious person.
- Do not delay emergency care for altered mental status.

When temporary self-care should stop

Heat exhaustion should improve with cooling; persistent symptoms need medical assessment.

Urgent warning signs

Confusion, collapse, seizure, very high body temperature or altered consciousness suggests heatstroke and requires emergency care with active cooling.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hydration
- Shade/rest breaks
- Light clothing
- Avoid peak heat when possible

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/heat-exhaustion-heatstroke/>

Suggested metadata: category=Emergency Recognition; topic=Heat Exhaustion / Heatstroke; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

60. Fainting

Category: Emergency Recognition Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

Fainting is a brief loss of consciousness from reduced blood flow to the brain; causes range from benign to serious.

What you can safely do now

- Lay the person flat if safe and raise legs if no injury prevents it.
- Loosen tight clothing and allow fresh air.
- When awake, let them sit up gradually.

Why these steps may help

- Lying flat improves blood flow to the brain and reduces fall risk.

What to avoid

- Do not immediately stand the person up.
- Do not give food/drink while unconscious.

When temporary self-care should stop

Medical review is appropriate for recurrent or unexplained fainting.

Urgent warning signs

Emergency care is needed if the person does not quickly recover, has chest pain, severe breathlessness, injury, seizure-like activity, pregnancy-related concerns or fainted during exercise.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Hydration
- Slow position changes
- Review recurrent episodes

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z
<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/fainting/>

Suggested metadata: category=Emergency Recognition; topic=Fainting; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

61. Seizure First Aid

Category: Emergency Recognition Corpus type: supportive_care_v3

What may be happening

A seizure can cause altered awareness, stiffening or jerking. Most stop by themselves, but safety during the event is crucial.

What you can safely do now

- Protect the person from injury by clearing nearby hazards.
- Cushion the head.
- Time the seizure.
- After jerking stops, place them on their side if breathing normally and stay with them.

Why these steps may help

- Removing hazards prevents trauma; side positioning helps keep the airway clear after the seizure.

What to avoid

- Do not restrain movements.
- Do not put anything in the mouth.
- Do not give food/drink until fully recovered.

When temporary self-care should stop

People with known epilepsy should follow their individualized seizure plan.

Urgent warning signs

Call emergency services for a first seizure, seizure lasting about 5 minutes or more, repeated seizures without recovery, serious injury, breathing problems, pregnancy, or seizure in water.

Prevention / reducing recurrence

- Medication adherence when prescribed
- Sleep and trigger management per care plan

Source for retrieval auditing

NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

<https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/what-to-do-if-someone-has-a-seizure-fit/>

Suggested metadata: category=Emergency Recognition; topic=Seizure First Aid; corpus_type=supportive_care_v3; source_authority=NHS Health A to Z / Symptoms A to Z

Corpus Notes for Health Assist AI

This version contains 61 practical topics. The design intentionally gives each topic its own page so the heading, immediate actions, rationale, red flags and source remain close together during PDF extraction.

For Pinecone ingestion, preserve topic/category/source as metadata. A future ingestion improvement should parse the topic heading and attach structured metadata rather than relying only on filename and page number.

Recommended retrieval priority: emergency query → WHO Basic Emergency Care; practical symptom-relief query → this supportive-care corpus; disease education query → current WHO/CDC/general medical corpus.